

VA TRACK • MENTOR SPOTLIGHT

# Ms. Fegs

*Umuteme Oghenefego Peace*

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*"I walk into disorder and leave with a system."*

A Mentor Spotlight | By Temilola Olayiwola

HNG Finalist

VA Mentor

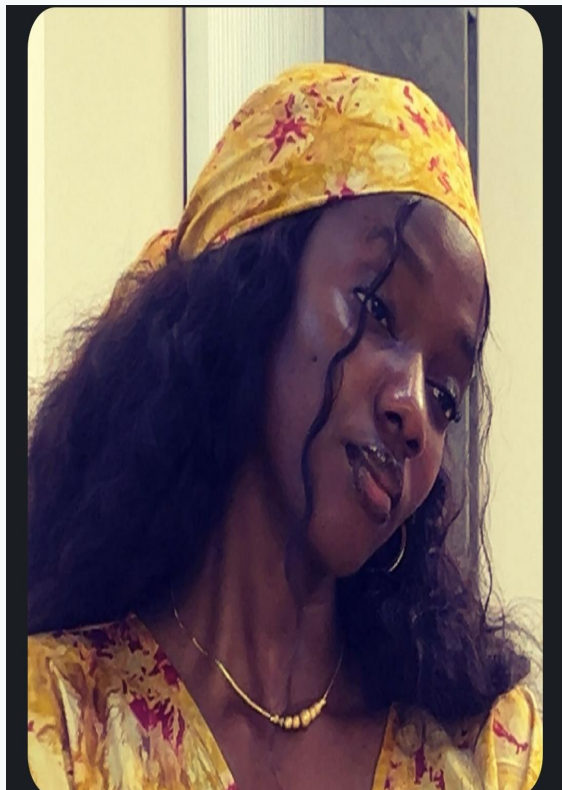
Operations Expert

Computer Science Graduate



# Who Is Ms. Fegs?

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## Education

Computer Science graduate, she doesn't just complete tasks, she understands how systems work and fixes them before they break.

## Profession

Virtual Assistant & Operations Expert. Supports founders and executives across multiple remote organizations simultaneously.

## HNG Role

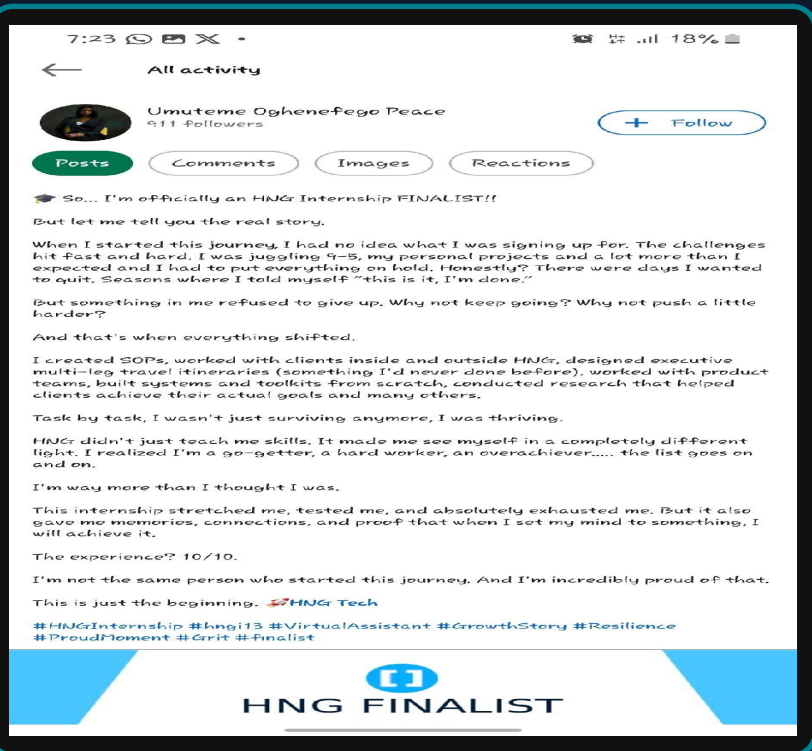
VA Mentor in the HNG Internship program. Guides interns through the VA track, shares updates, and publicly recognizes excellence.

## Philosophy

"I walk into disorder and leave with a system." Her entire professional identity in one sentence.

# Before She Was Your Mentor

*She was once exactly where you are now*



01

She juggled a 9-5, personal projects, and the internship all at once, just like many of us are doing right now.

02

There were days she wanted to quit. Seasons where she told herself 'this is it, I'm done.' She stayed anyway.

03

She created SOPs, designed executive travel itineraries, worked with real clients inside and outside HNG.

04

She went from surviving to thriving. Task by task, she proved to herself she was more than she thought.

05

"I'm not the same person who started this journey. And I'm incredibly proud of that." - Ms. Fegs



In Her Own Words

*"HNG didn't just teach me skills.  
It made me see myself in a completely different light.  
I realized I'm a go-getter, a hard worker, an overachiever.  
I'm way more than I thought I was."*

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- Ms. Fegs, HNG Finalist Post

# Her Professional Identity

## Systems Thinker

- She doesn't just complete tasks, she finds where processes break and fixes them before anyone has to ask.

## Remote Operations Expert

- Supported founders and executives across multiple remote organizations simultaneously for over a year.

## Trust-Based Operator

- Works best when trusted independently. Comfortable across time zones, confident with executives, careful with sensitive information.

## About

I am the person who walks into disorder and leaves with a system. For the past year, I have supported founders and executives across multiple remote organizations at the same time, keeping inboxes clean, calendars conflict-free, records organized, and communications moving without anything slipping through.

As a Computer Science graduate, I do not just complete tasks. I look at how a process works, find where it breaks, and fix it before anyone has to ask.

I work best when I am trusted to operate independently. I am comfortable across time zones, confident communicating with executives and clients alike, and careful with sensitive information. If you need someone who shows up, figures things out, and keeps things running quietly in the background, that is exactly what I do.

*"If you need someone who shows up, figures things out, and keeps things running quietly in the background, that is exactly what I do." - Ms. Fegs*

# First Impression: Taking Initiative

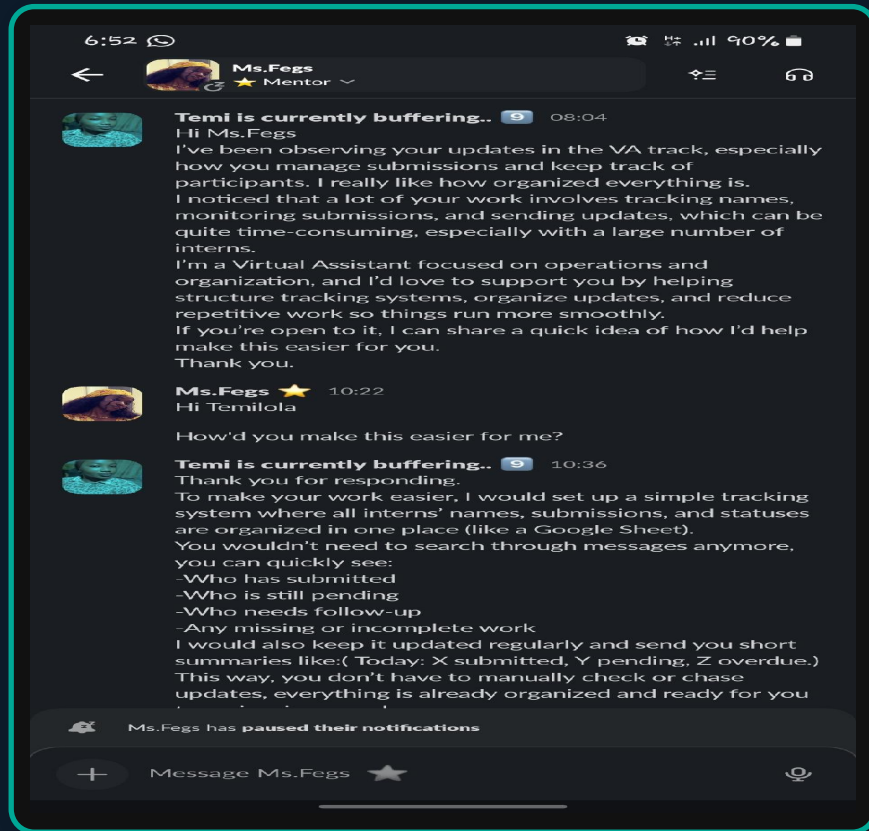
## What Happened

Early in the internship, I reached out to Ms. Fegs directly to pitch an idea, offering to build a tracking system to manage intern submissions more efficiently.

Rather than dismissing me, she engaged. She asked a single pointed question that stopped me in my tracks.

*"How'd you make this easier for me?"*

That one question taught me: a good mentor doesn't just receive ideas, she tests them. She wanted to see if I had truly thought it through.



# Clear, Calm & Direct

## Warm but Professional

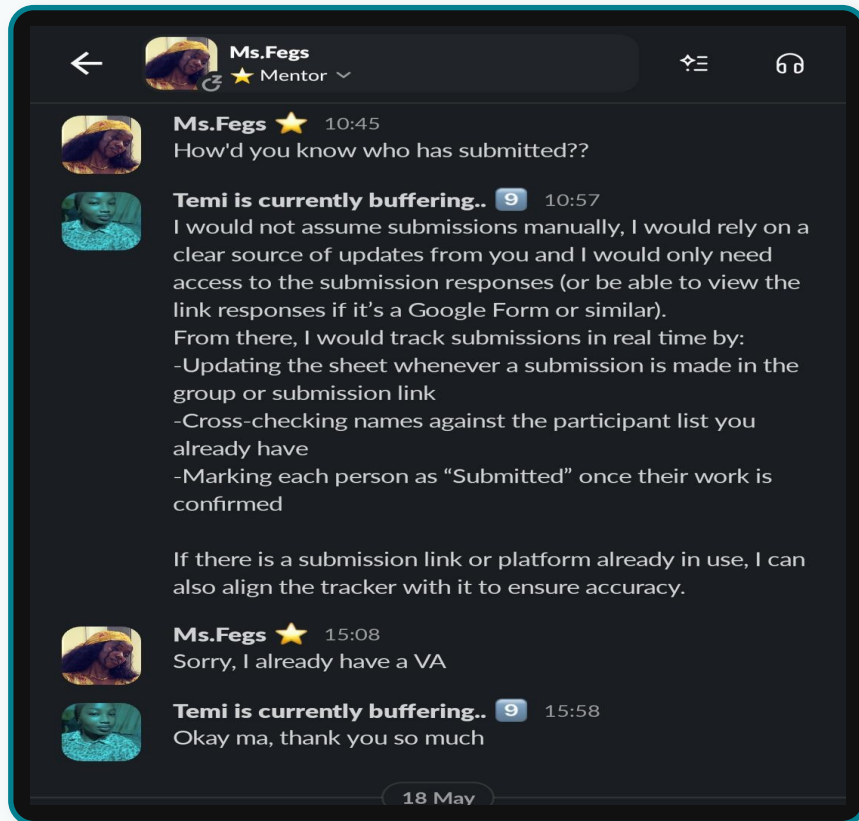
She greets, acknowledges, and responds with genuine care, always maintaining a professional tone in every interaction.

## Direct Without Being Harsh

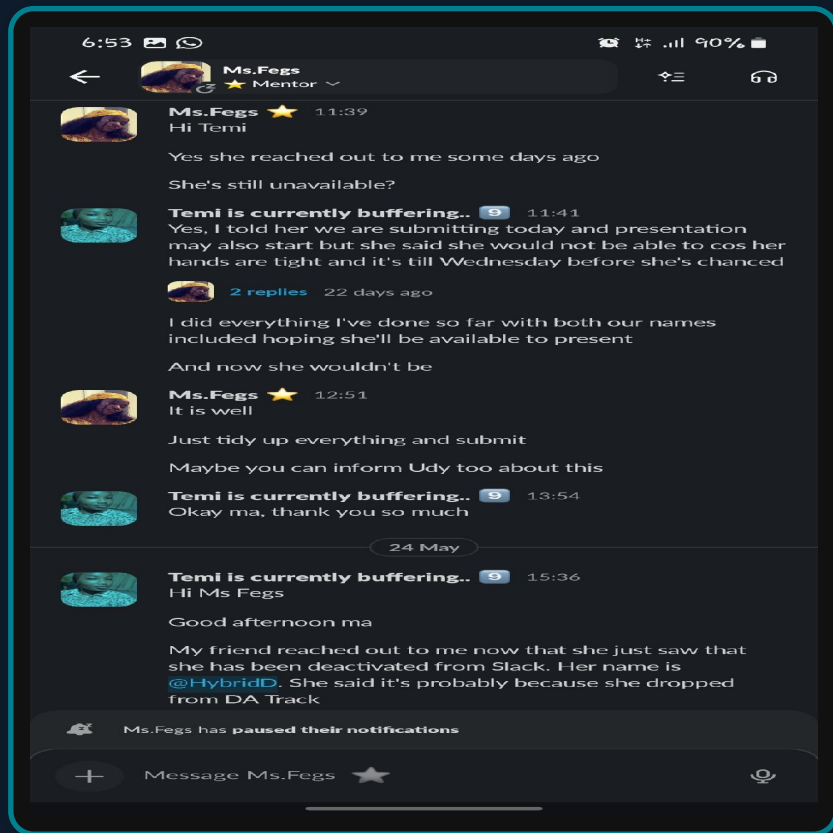
When she already had a VA, she said so clearly and kindly: "Sorry, I already have a VA." No mixed signals, no delay.

## Calm Under Pressure

"It is well. Just tidy up and submit." No panic. No drama. Just clear direction when things got stressful.



# Steady When It Matters



## How She Handles a Real Problem

My partner for a group task was unavailable close to the deadline. I came to Ms. Fegs unsure of what to do.

Her response was immediate and calm:

"It is well. Just tidy up everything and submit. Maybe you can inform Udy too."

No frustration. No lengthy back and forth. She acknowledged the situation, gave a clear next step, and let me move forward.

*Key Insight: Strong support means giving just enough direction to help someone move forward on their own.*



# Leading Without Being in Every Conversation

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*How she leads a large cohort through visibility, structure, and recognition*

## Timely Updates

Task briefs, deadlines, and program announcements are delivered clearly. Interns always know what's expected and when.

## Public Recognition

She gives kudos openly to interns who impress her, creating a culture where good work is visible and celebrated.

## Organised Communication

Every message has a clear intent. She never clutters the channel, her communications are purposeful and easy to act on.

## Big Picture Awareness

She monitors the entire cohort without micromanaging. She sees patterns, flags issues, and guides the group forward quietly.

# What Makes Ms. Fegs Stand Out

| Strength            | How It Shows Up                                                               | Why It Matters for VAs                                    |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| HNG Finalist        | She completed this exact internship, she knows every stage from the inside    | Her guidance is earned, not assumed                       |
| Systems Mindset     | Describes herself as someone who walks into disorder and leaves with a system | Models the core VA skill: operational clarity             |
| Calm Under Pressure | Responds with clear direction during stressful deadline situations            | Teaches VAs how to stay professional when things go wrong |
| Probing Leadership  | Asks follow-up questions that push interns to think deeper                    | Develops critical thinking, not just task completion      |
| Public Recognition  | Celebrates strong work openly in the channel                                  | Creates accountability and motivates the entire cohort    |

# A Philosophy Worth Studying

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*"I am the person who walks into disorder and leaves with a system."*

- Her professional bio

*"I work best when I am trusted to operate independently."*

- Her professional bio

*"Task by task, I wasn't just surviving anymore - I was thriving."*

- HNG Finalist post

*"This internship stretched me, tested me, and absolutely exhausted me. But it also gave me proof."*

- HNG Finalist post



# Lessons for Future Virtual Assistants

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1

Your past experiences are your foundation. Ms. Fegs built her VA career on the systems thinking she already had. Nothing is wasted.

2

Communicate with calm confidence - how you respond under pressure tells a client more about you than any portfolio ever could.

3

Build systems, not just habits, don't just complete tasks, understand the process behind them and improve it.

4

Resilience is a professional skill, she almost quit, she stayed, she thrived. That decision is always available to you too.

5

Test your ideas before pitching them. a good mentor (and a good client) will ask 'how?' Be ready with a real answer.

6

Recognition builds culture, notice good work in others. Whether you are a VA, a team lead, or a mentor, acknowledgement costs nothing.

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# Thank You, Ms. Fegs

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What makes Ms. Fegs remarkable is not just what she knows, it is the fact that she has lived it.

She was once an intern, juggling everything, wanting to quit, choosing to stay. She became an HNG Finalist. Then she came back to mentor the next generation.

That is the kind of professional I want to become, someone who grows through hard things and then reaches back to help others do the same.

Thank you for showing us what it looks like to show up, figure it out, and keep things running, quietly, and excellently.



Temilola Olayiwola | VA Track Internship | Mentor Spotlight